

Mata o Muna 6 | Chapter 6

Fakatokaga 'Lei o te Fenua | Maintaining Harmony with Family and Community

Te Gagana Tuvalu	English
A fenua katoa e iai ni faifaiga māhāni kolā e fakamoemoeina ke fakaaogā ni ana tino mo faka takitaki ki ai a ikuga 'lahi ia me foliki kolā e fai e lātou i pō taki tahi. E iai ni fakamoemoea e mafai o fakamuna maninogina pelā me ni tulafono. E iai ni fakamoemoea e pelā me a lagonaga māhāni ki luga i te auala tonu ia me 'tau o faigina e tino, te auala telā e 'tau o lagonagina e tino i tulaga fakapogai, ia me ko auala kolā e 'tau o fai a tino ki tino. A fakamoemoea māhāni konei e mafai o laveagina ite ata ote olaga māhāni i pō taki tahi. Hē mafai o fakamatala faka 'lei, ma ko te mea e fakavae kiai hoki a faifaiga, mafauauga mo lagonaga o tino.	Every society has cultural expectations that people use to guide the many large and small decisions they make every day. Some of these expectations can be stated fairly clearly as rules. Others are more general feelings about the right way for people to behave, how people should feel in certain situations, or the ways that others should be treated. These general expectations lie underneath the surface of day-to-day life. Even though they are not explicitly expressed very often, they nonetheless form the bedrock for people's actions, thoughts and feelings.
E māhāni o iai he hokoga 'lei i te vāhia o fakamoemoea māhāni mo tulāfono kolā koa oti ni fakamatala 'lei. Kae e mafai o hē fetai a te hokoga tenei hoki. A tulāfono mo fakamoemoea e mafai loa o hē fealofani ia lātou, telā koa mafai i ai o fakamafua e lātou a hē maliega mo finauga manafai a tino koa fai e lātou a filifiliga kolā e talitonu lātou me e 'tonu i te pulāga a faifaiga māhāni. Te mea nei ko te galiga ote tulaga faka'numi o faifaiga māhāni i Nanumea mo fenua ake.	Often there is a good connection between general expectations and more clearly stated rules. However, sometimes their fit is imperfect. Some rules and expectations may even contradict each other, leading to disputes and arguments when people make different choices that each believes to be culturally correct. Such is the wonderful complexity of culture, in Nanumea and everywhere!
Te mataupu tenei koa pula kia fakamoemoea tāua kolā e faka takitaki ki ai a faifaiga māhāni o te olaga o te tino Nanumea. E pelā me koa iai he fakatau maliega fakatahi e uiga mo te lahiiga o fakamoemoea konei, pelā hoki i luga i te tulaga o te fakatau, kae faitalia iai, i he taimi a tino e mafai loa o 'heke te lotou 'pula me koa fakagālua pehea a fakamoemoea konei ki he tulaga fakapogai. E kāmata 'tou 'pulāga ki te ata lahi katoatoa o mafauauga tāua i luga i te fakanohonohoga o te kāiga mo haga fai o kāiga ki olotou kāiga.	This chapter looks at some of the important expectations that guide Nanumean cultural life. There tends to be broad agreement about most of these expectations, at least in principle, though people sometimes may differ about how the expectations should be applied to particular situations. We begin with an overview of some important ideas about family organization and the responsibilities that relatives have to each other. We then turn our attention to expectations concerning community life, domains of authority and collective obligations.
Fakamoemoea mo Faifaiga Māhāni a Kāiga	Kāiga Expectations and Traditions
I loto i te olaga o te tino Nanumea e iai he putu kauga a tino kolā e fakaigoa ko oku kano me ko toku kāiga. A kāiga konei e 'tele mai i te gafa e tahi mai i te ukega o tupuga taumua e noho pelā ki te lima me ko te ono o kautama koa fano. A hokoga ki feitu e lua o he kāiga e tahi e tāua (a kāiga e tau atu ki te feitu o te tamana mo te matua o he tino), kae ko lātou kolā e kāiga i te	Centered around every Nanumean person is a group of people called oku kano or toku kāiga. These relatives share lines of descent (gafa, telega) from one of several ancestors, going back five or even six generations into the past. Connection to both sides of one's family is important (relatives linked both through one's

feitu o te tamana e māhāni o fakatāua atu mālosi i tulaga valevale o te olaga.

A te hokoga telā e fakamailoga iai a kāiga e mafai o lavea i mea kolā e fiafia ki ai lātou o fai me ko aofaga kolā e umeke ki ai lātou. A kāiga e tauave tahi hoki e lātou a lotou uiga fai mo luma, telā lā e fakamoemoegina ke fakatau avake e lātou io me fakatau fesoasoani ki te avakega o fakamoemoega mo te ola 'lei o tino o te lotou kāiga.

A te māhāni, a kope tāua mo te ola 'lei o he kāiga e tausigina e he kau kāiga kolā e tupuga tahi. Te faifaiga tenei e hē fakatino tonu ailoa ki laukele, vai pulaka, fale 'noho mo vaka, kae fakatino hoki ki luga i iloga māhāni kolā e māhāni o fakaholo ki lalo i kautama gāholo. A te iloga o kāiga tenei e mafai o aofia iai a logo mo fakalei mahaki, faika, fai kaleve, 'toki lākau, me ko he galuega fai mo ola iai a te kāiga, e pelā hoki mo fakahologa o kāiga, tala māhāni fakaholo gafa, pehe mo tala.

Te Āva ki Tino Matua

I pō nāteahō, a kaufale taki tahi e fakalagolago ki luga i feao ke tauti ni lātou te ola 'lei o lotou kāiga. A te ivi fuapiho o feao konei ni tauti i loto i momea tapu o te kaufale, ni fakahinugina e he taumatua telā tona ivi fuapiho ka faopoopo ki te tuku fakatahiga i he taimi mai mua.

Faitalia i te koe he tagata io me he fafine, e 'tau o fakaali atu a te āva ki luga i tino matua i te mea te lotou iloa i te olaga fai mo te lotou atamai koa oti ni maua e lātou i tauhaga e fia e ola mai iai a lātou. A te fakatauga tenei e fai mo fai te fakavae o te fakapotopotoga o tino Nanumea.

A tupulaga foliki mo tino o te kāiga iai he lotou tiute fai fakatahi. Te lotou tiute tenei ko te fiafia o tuku fakatahi olotou mālosi ki luga i mea fai a te kāiga kae o talia hoki a fakatonutonuga mo fakatakitakiga kolā e aumai e tino matuatua o te kāiga, e fakaali atu iai a te lotou āva mo te fiafia o fakataunu a fakatonuga kolā ni fai mai kia lātou.

Feitu Kolā e Pulepulegina e Tāgata mo Fāfine

Tāgata mo fāfine e iai katoa a olotou tiute tāua e fai i tū mo faifaiga faka Nanumea, kae e iai loa ni tū mo faifaiga, kolā koa 'heke iai a tiute fai o

father and one's mother), though those on the father's side can be privileged in some contexts.

The bond of identity between relatives assumes common interests and goals. Relatives share character (uiga) and reputation (luma), and thus are expected to promote each other's interests and well-being. This is easiest to accomplish for people who live together in the same household. Thus, it is not surprising to find that Nanumean households are often large, containing many extended family relatives in addition to the core of parent(s) and child(ren).

Traditionally, the resources essential for family well-being were held in common by a related group of descendants. This was true not only for land, taro pits, houses and canoes but also for the traditional knowledge passed down through generations. This family lore might include special techniques for healing, fishing, canoe making, toddy production, gardening or other subsistence tasks, as well as genealogies, traditional history, songs and stories.

Respect for Elders

In ancient times, each household relied on its feao (ancestral gods) to maintain the wellbeing of the family. The skulls of these gods were kept in a household shrine, propitiated (prayed to), oiled by an elder whose skull would someday be added to the collection as an ancestor.

Regardless of gender, elders should be shown the respect due their experience and the wisdom they have accumulated over the years. This principle provides the foundation for Nanumean society.

Younger relatives and family members have a reciprocal obligation. This was to generously contribute energy to family activities and to accept direction and guidance offered by their elder relatives, showing them respect by cheerfully doing as directed. Younger people should express opinions when asked, but they should refrain from being too assertive and speaking out too opinionatedly.

Areas of Responsibility and Control for Men and Women

Men and women both play essential roles in Nanumean culture, but the customary activities assigned to each gender are different. Men have

tāgata mo fāfine. A tāgata e iai ailoa ni olotou tiute fakapogai mo olotou kāiga (pelā hoki mo fakapotopotoga), e pelā hoki ailoa mo fāfine.

A fāfine e fai e lātou a te ukega o ikuga fai a kāiga i pō taki tahi. E fakatonu e lātou a galuega a tino tai foliki o te kaufale, e tausi e lātou a tamaliki, fakahoa e lātou a te fakaogaaga o lotou kope mo maumea, tausi e lātou a te ola 'lei o tino o te kaufale, fakahoa e lātou a sene o te kāiga.

Kae ko tāgata, e māhani o faika, kake i niu, fakaola a talo mo pulaka, tausi a laukele o te kāiga, mo vaka, mo fale faka'tau ki luga i te lotou matua mo te lotou mālosi.

Takitakiga o Kāiga

A tino Nanumea e māhani o fai tele olotou muna me i tonu e faigina ei tāgata kae ko te fakataunuuga e faigina e fāfine. Te fakamunaga māhani tenei e māhani o fakauiga ki luga i olaga o kāiga mo faifaiga a fakapotopotoga. Te fakamunaga tenei e fakapātonu hoki e ia a te gālua fakatahi o tiute fai o tāgata mo fāfine.

A hokoga i te vāhia o tāgata mo fāfine o he kaufale e māhani ailoa o manino kae tāua, ke oko hoki ailoa ki galuega fai kolā tai lahi atu o te fenua.

Te Tāua o te Kāiga Lahi

A te lahi o he kāiga e fakatāuagina, telā e uke a faifaiga māhani e fesoasoani ki te tausiga o vāhia o tino Nanumea kolā e kāiga kae ko tai 'mao. E maopopo a lātou manafai ko iai he pepe ni fanau, me he mate, e me ko he fakaipoipoga. E fakatau fesoasoani, fakamafanafana kae fakatonutonu.

A uiga atafai o koe, hē fai pelā ko te toto tahi ailoa o koe mo he tino, e fakaali e ia me koai ou kāiga me pehea hoki te lahi o tou puipui kāiga tenā. Fia kano, ko uiga kolā e fakaali iai a te alofa mo te atafai, fakatahi mo te fakatāua e koe a ou vāhia mo tou kāiga lahi.

their own particular responsibilities to their families (and also to the community), just as do women. Generally speaking, men interface between the family and the wider community, while women engage primarily within the family or within a particular group.

Women make most of the practical decisions of daily household life. They direct the labor of younger household members, look after children, organize access to and use of resources, facilitate the health of household members, take charge of the family budget, and connect with various groups that do the work of the island.

Men typically fish, climb for coconuts, grow taro and pulaka, and maintain family lands, canoes/boats, and houses as their abilities and age allow.

Family Leadership

Nanumeans typically say that men make decisions and women carry them through to completion. This generalization is applied both to family life and to community affairs. It emphasizes the complementarity of men's and women's roles, but it is also a simplification that discounts the huge influence that women have on decision-making at its most basic level, namely within the family.

On-going consultation between men and women of a household is essential, just as it is in any of the larger projects of the island. Women's control over household resources gives them practical authority behind-the-scenes to which men must pay attention.

Importance of Extended Family

Having a wide circle of relatives is valued, and many particular cultural institutions help to maintain links between distant Nanumean relatives. Ideally, a wide circle of relatives support each other in all the various situations and challenges of life. They rally around at birth, death and marriage. They provide moral support, comfort and advice.

Caring behavior, not just shared genealogy, determines who is included in the active circle of relatives and how broad that circle is. Fia kano, behaviors that demonstrate alofa and concern, combine with the value given to extended family relationships to create a flexible system that can

Te Puke o Tamaliki

A taulua āvaga kolā e hē mafai o maua ni lā tama tonu, e mafai o fakanā ki luga i olotou kāiga mailoga loa olotou kāiga 'pili, ke puke mai iai ni olotou tamaliki. A kāiga taki tauluāvaga kolā e fanafanau e māhani o fakaali a te lotou alofa o tuku atu ni lotou tamaliki taki tahi ko te mea ke mafai e olotou taina me ko tuagane o lagona te fakafiafiaga telā manafai e iai ni au tamaliki.

A tino Nanumea e fai pelā me i te tama puke e 'tau ailoa o atafai faka'lei kī. A te tamaliki puke e 'tau o motautana ana galuega, kae fagai hoki ki meakai kolā e malie ki ai. Kafai koa tai lahi, koa fakatonutonu e ia a faifaiga o ana taina mo tuagane, kae fai hoki a ia mo pule o te fanauga.

Te Faka 'Mauluga i te Vāhia o Tuagane

A te vāhia faka taina e 'tau o fakatāualofa kae fesoasoani, kae ko te vāhia faka tuagane e 'tau o atafai faka'lei ke lahi a te faka'maluga ki ai. A te tuagane e 'tau o faka ava ki olotou tuagane ki he tulaga mauluga ailoa. E tapu hoki a te fakamasiasigina o tuagane ite mea "koa tapu a te 'ligi o loimata o te tuagane."

E hilia atu hoki a te fakaeteete ki te faka āvaga ki luga i faka tuagane kolā koa tai 'mao atu pelā mo tua fa, tua lima, tua ono. Muna a tino, me i faka tuagane konei tai 'mao, ka fai koa lavea he tino i tona tuagane koa haele mai i te auala o te fakkai, e 'taua te faka tuagane o 'fuli a tena auala.

Tuātina

A te vāhia faka tuātina e faka'hoko a tuagane o te fafine ki tna tamaliki. A tuātina e faka ava kī kae fakaakoi kī ki olotou tuātina. A lātou e fakamoemogina ke fesoasoani ki olotou tuātina i taimi e manakogina iai he fesoasoani, faitalia loa te faigatā mo te fakamatakuga telā e aofia i te manakoga.

expand and contract with the reciprocal needs of the people involved.

Adoption

Couples who are not successful in having children of their own turn to their relatives, especially close relatives, for adoptive children. Siblings often show their alofa by giving up one (or sometimes more) of their own children so that their taina or tuagane can enjoy the pleasures of having a family, or of having both sons and daughters.

Nanumeans say that an adopted child should be treated especially well. An adopted child may be given less work to do than siblings and offered choice food. When older, it will direct the affairs of its sibling group, becoming te pule o te fanauga. Adoptions are often formalized by registration with the government.

Respect between Tuagane

Taina relationships should be caring and cooperative, but tuagane relationships must be careful and highly respectful. Tuagane must faka ava to each other to the point of deference. This is best accomplished by avoiding each other's casual company. People say that tuagane are to be more venerated than siblings of the same sex. They must not be provoked or embarrassed since "koa tapu o ligi loimata o tuagane" ("it is forbidden to spill the tears of a tuagane").

Special care is required between more distant (fourth, fifth, sixth) cousins. People say that if distant opposite-sex cousins see each other approaching on a village path, one of them should change course to avoid their meeting. In gossiping and joking, people must be careful not to relate critical, embarrassing or sexually-orientated stories in the presence of his or her tuagane.

Tuātina

The tuātina relationship links a woman's brother and her child. Tuātina owe each other great respect and commitment. They are expected to help each other as needed or requested, regardless of the hardship or danger involved. Lovers whose parents refuse to allow their marriage may beg for support and permission from a tuātina.

A vāhia faka tuātina e fakamālosi e lātou a te hokoga o tamaliki a te fafine mo ona kāiga, i luga i te fofitino o tona tuagane. Koa lahi a te kāiga i te feitu o te matua i te mea o te hokoga tenei i vāhia o tuātina taki tahi.

Ko Fakamoemoega mo Faifaiga Māhani a te Fenua

Mai taimi nāteahō ailoa ke oko mai ki taimi nei, a tū mo faifaiga faka Nanumea koa oti ni fakavae ki luga i te 'kaufakatahi o te fenua. A te loto fiafia o kāiga o gālue fakatahi mo te ola 'lei o tino katoa, mo te lototahi o tino taki tokotahi o fakafealofani a olotou fakamoemoega mo olotou manakoga ki galuega kolā e manuia iai a te fenua, koa lahi te taliagina e tino e pelā me he auala 'lei telā e 'tau o olagina e he tino Nanumea.

A te loto talitonu telā e lagonagina e tino Nanumea mo te motou fenua, mo te 'tou loto fiafia o faopoopo atu a te mālosi mo te maumea o tauti a te mālosi o te fenua, he faifaiga hili kae tāua kī. Kae te loto gātahi, mea hili kae tāua kī, koa gaholoholo ailoa o hē ai kae faka hē aogāgina e manakoga o te olaga o pō nei.

Tautino Fai ki Gāluega Atiake a te Fenua

I pō nāteahō i Nanumea, a vaega kehekehe katoa o te mālō ni 'togigina e kope kolā ni mafai o akutugina fakatahi e te fenua. A niu he tusaga māhani telā e mafai o ofogina e tino, pelā hoki mo ika ni tāua 'kī i pō koa olo.

A te ata o te faifaiga māhani e tau atu ki luga i tautino fai a te fenua e manino ailoa. A tino kolā e iai ni olotou kope/koloa e fakamoemoegina ke fakaaogā fiafia fakatahi e lātou mo te fenua. A tino fai meaalofo e fakaaali atu e lātou a te lotou tautua tonu ki Nanumea mo te olotou tāua ki te fenua.

Fakaua

A fakaua ko vaeavaega kolā e 'hoko e lātou a kope/koloa o te kāiga mo manakoga o te fenua. I Nanumea i pō nei, a feitu e lua ko Lolua mo

Tuātina relationships strengthen connections between a woman's children and her relatives, through the person of her tuagane. A wide circle of relatives on the mother's side are drawn into greater contact as individual tuātina interact with each other. Thus, the institution of a special relationship between tuātina helps to offset the emphasis on tele tagata, descent through males.

Community-wide Expectations and Traditions

From very ancient times all the way down to the present, Nanumean culture has been founded on community cohesion. The willingness of families to work together for the well-being of everyone, and the willingness of individuals to link their own hopes and desires to activities benefiting the fenua, has long been accepted as the way to live a good Nanumean life.

The loyalty that Nanumeans feel for our fenua, and our willingness to contribute energy and resources to maintain its strength, is a cultural treasure. But it is a very vulnerable treasure. Loto gātahi is being eroded and undermined by the demands of modern life, especially by values that highlight individual responsibility and achievement.

Contribution to Fenua Projects

In ancient Nanumea, every aspect of local government was funded by the materials that could be amassed by community members. Coconuts were the basis for many of the contributions people made, and fish were important in the past too. Spectacular donations to the community as a whole were encouraged traditionally.

The traditional pattern regarding community contributions is clear. People with resources are expected to share them generously with the community. Donors demonstrate their allegiance to Nanumea and their importance to the community, gaining status that will translate eventually into a leadership role.

Fakaua

Fakaua are currently the units that connect family resources with the needs of the fenua. In Nanumea today, the two "village sides" (feitu) of

Haumeafa ko vaega 'lahi konā koa vaevae mai iai a fakaua.

E lua pogai kolā e tāua iai a lātou. E tahi, a te faifaiga faka fakaua e fakatalia e ia ko matakāiga, ke fuafua loa e lātou me e lava olotou kope/koloa mo fai tele olotou tautino/tufaga. Te lua, a fakaua kolā e kau i mea fai koa maua e lātou a faitu 'lei.

Te 'Hekēga o te Fenua mo te Mālō

A tino Nanumea e māhani tele o faka'kehe e lātou a te fenua (Nanumea, ana tino, mo ana fakanohoga māhani) mo te mālō (mālō mai tua, e kau iai a te pulepulega faka kolone mai te mālō o Peletania ia me ko te mālō lahi a pō nei). A te 'hekega tenei (fenua/mālō) e māhani o fakaaogā i pō nei o fakamaina iai me ko ai e 'tau o pule e ia a te faiga o tonu kehekehe.

Fakapaleniga o te Tautua Fakamaoni ki te Kāiga mo te Fenua

A kāiga Nanumea mo tino taki tokotahi ni hepaki tele ailoa mo te fakalavelave tenei, kae koa na gaholo o faigatā a te mataupu tenei i pō nei. A tino koa gaholo mālosi o fakamālosigina ia me faimalogina ke fai/'pula kia lātou e pelā me ni tino fakatau mea.

Pelā mo manakoga o tino o te kāiga ki luga i mea tau sene koa fanake ki luga, koa mafai o lavea a te fanaifo ki lalo o kope/koloa kolā e mafai o tuku atu ki te fenua. Heā a te pokotiaga o te tulaga tenei ki luga i te mālosi o te fenua mo faifaiga māhani?

Te Faka'malu ki Tofiiga

I pō nāteahō i Nanumea, a takitaki kolā e 'noho mo tofiga 'pulepule ni lahi a te faka'mauluga/fakaavāga ki ai o tino. A ata konei e fai mai me i te pulāga māhani a Nanumea ki te lalolagi, a te mālosi ni olo tahi mo te haga. A tino e matemate ake ke tautua e ia he tofiga pulepule e 'tau o mafai e ia o fakaali he ata tautua fakamaoni kae tautali ki luga i uiga 'tau.

Lolua and Haumeafa provide larger competitive groupings within which fakaua are members.

There are at least two reasons for their effectiveness. Firstly, the fakaua system allows family groups themselves to determine whether their resources are sufficient to regularly provide a contribution. Secondly, participating fakaua benefit from their participation. The family proves that it has a rightful place in both decision-making and festivities.

Fenua / Mālō Distinction

Nanumeans routinely distinguish between te fenua (Nanumea, its people, and traditional institutions) and te mālō (the external government, including British colonial or current national governments). The fenua/mālō contrast is often used today to clarify where control over different types of decisions should lie, or who should take responsibility for providing resources for a particular project.

Balancing Loyalty to Family and Fenua

Nanumean families and individuals have always faced this challenge, but it is an especially poignant issue today. People are increasingly enticed, urged, even commanded to see themselves as consumers. This can create solidarity within families.

As family members' needs for money increase, there may be an inevitable decline in the resources that can be given to the fenua. What effect will this have on the strength of the community and on our traditional culture? Perhaps we should be doing more to create loyalty to the fenua among the next generation of young men and women?

Respect for Tofi

In ancient Nanumea, leaders filling high positions of authority were treated with great respect. These examples suggest that in the traditional Nanumean worldview, power was linked with responsibility. Anyone presuming to occupy a position of authority must be able to demonstrate a life-long commitment to accepted ideals of behavior, and to follow these principles while occupying that role.

Alofa ki Falepili

A te mālosi o te fenua e fakamālosigina hoki e te faifaiga māhani ko te fakaogā fakatahi o kope/koloa mo falepili. I Nanumea, a falepili e māhani o fakamoemoegina ke fai fakatahi olotou ika, mo laulau meakai ake, kae matapulapula ake hoki ki auala kolā e mafai iai lātou o fakatau luani. A te alofa telā e fakaaligina i falepili i Nanumea e atili fakamālosi atu e ia a te mālosi o te fenua.

Te Fakaalofa

Toe manatu, a tino Nanumea e māhani o fakaaofia e lātou e tino 'fou ki loto i te fenua. A tino kolā e au'mai ki te fenua kae hē ai ni olotou kāiga telā koa hē ai hoki e olotou laumanafa, e fakaigoagina e fakaalofa. E uke a auala i faifaiga faka Nanumea kolā e 'fō iai a te tulaga tenei pelā mo te faka'kau/faka'hoko tahi atu a vaega tino penei ki luga i ni putukau faka tātou.

Tausiga o te Filemu i Tulaga Faigatā

A fakamoemoega kolā ni fakamatala mai i luga mo vāhia o kāiga mo te fenua e 'tau o fai e lātou a te olaga i Nanumea ke filemu kae 'kau fakatahi. I te ukega o taimi, tenei tonu ailoa a te mea e tupu. Kae e iai ni tulaga fakalavelave ko 'tupu kolā koa fakamafua iai a faka-finauga. Ni ā faifaiga māhani kolā e luani ki te fenua ke fakafeagai mo vaega fakalavelave penei?

Oge mo te Vaelua

A Nanumea, I te faitu ki te mātū loa o te Atu Tuvalu, e māhani tele o pokotia ni taulā kolā faigatā telā a te laukele koa hē ola, mo tino hoki koa mafai o pokotia e te fakamataku o te fia'kai. I pō nāteahō o Nanumea, a taulā e fakatupu e ia he fakalavelave lahi ki luga i te olaga.

A Nanumea ko oti ni faite e ia he auala gali ni fakagoa ki te vaelua, e avake iai a te aofaki o tino tokouke o te fenua ke mafai o 'hao i taimi o he taulā faigatā. Koa hē tuku ailoa ki kāiga taki tahi

Alofa to Falepili

Community strength was also enhanced by the local custom of sharing resources with neighbors, falepili. Being generous to relatives assures people of all sorts of support and assistance but it also creates limited circles of allegiance. Customs that reach out beyond extended family groups to create links between non-related households are a special kind of glue needed to create a tight community. The alofa shown by falepili throughout Nanumea gives extra strength to the community.

Tino Fakaalofa

Nanumeans traditionally have brought newcomers into the embracing circle of te fenua. People who come to the island without relatives and thus without access to land are termed fakaalofa. Nanumean custom provides several ways to remedy this by connecting these people with a local group. Often this connection takes the form of adoption into a particular family, with the newcomer filling relationships appropriate to their age and gender.

Maintaining Order in Situations of Difficulty

The expectations described above for family and community relationships should make life in Nanumea very peaceful and cohesive. Most of the time, this is exactly what happens. However, traumatic events sometimes happen and conflicts sometimes break out. What traditional customs helped the community to cope with these dangers?

Oge and Vaelua

Nanumea, in far northern Tuvalu, periodically suffers from droughts that are so severe that its vegetation dies back and people are in danger of starvation. In ancient Nanumea, droughts posed a terrible challenge to survival. The only thing that the community could do was to be prepared with a supply of stored food and then to carefully ration whatever food remained.

Nanumea had developed an ingenious way, called vaelua, to increase the chances that as many community members as possible would survive a bad drought. Rather than simply letting each family fend for itself, community leaders took

ke tausi e lātou a lātou ailoa, kae koa pule o te fenua koa fakahoa e lātou.

E hau ailoa te fakatokaga tenei ki te vaelua ni hē mafai e ia o fakamaui ni meakai tai uke atu, kae koa mafai loa o fakapatonu e ia me i meakai ko vaeveagina faka'pau ailoa i tino taki tokotahi o te fenua. A tino Nanumea koa fia'kai fakatahi, kae ka fai e hē ai he taulā ni tupu ailoa ki te hē gata mai, te tokoukega o tino Nanumea ni mafai loa o 'hao mai i taimi faigatā.

Fakasalaga Faka Te Fenua

A tino Nanumea ni māhāni o 'lahi olotou fakamoemoega mo te 'lei mo te fakaaloaloga o uiga o tino o te fenua. Kae mai i luga i fakasalaga māhāni penei, e iai hoki loa a auāla fakatoka/fakanohoga 'malu a te fenua e fakaaogā l pō mua mo fakasala iai he tino telā ona uiga e fakamataku e ia a te filemu o te fenua katoa. E fā a fakanohoga konei e fakamatala atu i konei.

Polopoloaki

A te fenua e iai hana auāla mua e fakafeagai iai mo he tamatane (ia me tino ake hoki) telā ni iloagina me fakafiufiu e ia a tino ia me fakamahe i e ia a kope 'lei o te fenua, kae te fakasalaga tenei e 'kave ki loto i te āhiga ke polopoloakigina e te fenua.

A te fenua katoa e 'mai ki loto i te āhiga. A te tino telā koa fakasalagina koa noho i luga i he kapau fakatugatuga i loto i te galoto o te āhiga, kae 'fuli ona mata ki takitaki o te fenua. A tukumuna e tu ake ki luga kae fakamatala e ia ki te fenua me aiā e 'ami atu iai lātou ke 'mai fakatahi ki te āhiga.

Fakatapu

Ka fai he tino e hē talia e ia o fai a uiga kolā e 'tau o faigina he tino o te fenua, koa ahi atu ki ai he putukau foliki o te fenua o fakamolemole ki ai ke 'fuli ona uiga. Ka fai te tino tenei e hē talia e ia a te fautuaga tenei kae tumau ailoa te faiga o ona uiga hē 'lei, koa toe ahi atu ki ai he putukau tai maluga atu. Koa fai e tumau ailoa i ona uiga hē 'lei, te fenua loa koa fakasala e ia ki te fakatapu.

Fakafolau

control. They divided the population into two equal groups, family by family.

Although the vaelua arrangement could not create any more food for people to eat, it could ensure that food would be apportioned equally among all community members. A family with more land would not eat while another family with less went hungry. Nanumeans might starve together but, because no drought lasted forever, most Nanumeans would also survive the hard times.

Traditional Punishments -- Fakasalaga Faka te Fenua

Nanumeans traditionally held high expectations for the orderly and respectful behavior of community members. Beyond informal sanctions, there were also more formal procedures that the community traditionally used to discipline someone whose behavior threatened the good order of the island as a whole. Four of these procedures are described here.

Public Reprimand -- Polopoloaki

The community formerly had a way of dealing with a young man (or anyone) who was known to harass people or to destroy the goods of the community, and this punishment was to be taken to the āhiga to be reprimanded by the community.

All the community came to the āhiga. The person receiving the reprimand was made to sit on a rough kapau mat in the center of the hall, facing the community leaders. The speaker stood up and explained to the community why they had been asked to come together and what wrong the person had committed.

Ostracism -- Fakatapu

When someone refuses to behave in the ways that an upstanding community member should, a small group of people usually visit the person and urge him to reform. Should the person ignore this advice and stubbornly persist, he will be given another warning by a higher-level delegation. If he still continues in his misbehavior, the island may impose a fakatapu on him. A fakatapu forbids any one from interacting with the person or helping him in any way.

Being Set Adrift -- Fakafolau

A te veaga fakahalaga tenei e māhai o fakaogā ki tino 'fou e oloatu ki te fenua, ka eiai ni olotou uiga faka'tupu fakalavelave, ka e mafai hoki ailoa o fakaogā ki tinā tino Nanumea. A te fakafolau e fai ki tino kolā e fia faitaua, tino fia 'hili, fia lavea kae fakamata'mata.

'Ta Mate Ailoo

E pelā mo te fakamatala atuga i te Mata o Muna 3 i faiga faka te fenua, kae fai he tino e amioga fakamaualuga i loto i te āhiga, e mafai ailoa o oko atu ki te 'ta. E tahi mai ai ko te tala ia Kafika, he tāgata koa tai pā tāgata, kae ni kalaga fakamatamata a ia i te pō e tahi kae kaukau a ia i te namo.

Fuliga mo Fakahuihuiga o Igoa

A igoa pelā hoki ailoa me olotahi mo uiga o he tino i Nanumea, telā a te fuliga o he igoa, he auala hoki e tahi e mafai i ai o 'fuli a uiga o he tino. Penei, ka e fai he tamaliki e tumau ailoa a te fai amioga kōlā e hē fīafia ki ai a tino, a ona mātua me ko ona kāiga e mafai o mafaufau ke fuli a tona igoa.

A te huiga o igoa e mafai hoki o luani ki te fake'leiga o kāiga. I te taimi a matakāiga koa loto malie ke tuku faka'tea ake a olotou hē maliega, a putukau konei e lua e mafai o fakamālosigina a te mafaufauga tenei ki te 'huiakiga o igoa o tino o lātou.

This kind of punishment was mainly used for troublesome outsiders, though it could also be used for Nanumeans as well. Setting adrift might be applied to people whose character was aggressive, overly domineering, or who were intolerably showoffs or boastful.

Being Killed Outright -- 'Ta Mate Ailoo

As was described in Chapter 3, in traditional times someone who behaved outrageously, especially in the āhiga, could be set upon and killed. There are several examples of the killing of troublemakers remembered in oral tradition. One such case was that of Kafika, an elderly man who boasted loudly one day as he bathed in the lagoon about all the people he had killed.

Changing and Exchanging Names

Names seem to be associated with one's behavior in Nanumea, so that changing one's name is a way to change behavior. For example, if a child repeatedly engages in behavior that people find offensive, its parents or other relatives might suggest changing its name. This might be done if a child is overly-aggressive or lazy.

Name changing can also help quarrelling families to reconcile. Once family members have agreed to put their disagreements aside, the two groups might cement this decision by exchanging some names with each other. Since names normally are bestowed within family lines, this practice signals to the entire community that these families have made an important change.